

SUNDAY 13 SEPTEMBER 2026

Twenty Fourth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 14 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm, Grotto
Tuesday 15 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 16 Sept	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Mass, 10.00am, <i>with school children attending</i>
Thursday 17 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon, <i>with school children attending Mass</i>		
Friday 18 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon, <i>with school children attending Mass</i>	
Saturday 19 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm: <i>Months Mind - Danny O'Donnell</i>	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 20 Sept	Mass, 11.00am	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Drumnabey, 12.30pm <i>Mass in Castlederg on 2nd and 4th Sunday</i>	Mass, 11.00am

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £923 & €65. **Church Restoration Fund:** £735 & €35.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,014 & €30, made up of:

Castlederg £1,179 & €24, **Drumnabey** £561 & €1, **Dregish** £274 & €5. **DRUMQUIN:** £694.

We gratefully acknowledge receipt of £250 donation for church funds in Castlederg. Thank you.

As always, thank you very much to all who contribute by Standing Order.

ARDSTRAW WEST AND CASTLEDERG Parish Draw: Returns for September's draw should be made to the Parochial House this Thursday, 17 September, between 6.00 and 7.30pm. The next draw will take place on Sunday 27 September in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg.

There are just a few tickets left – if you are not in the draw but would like to join, talk to the promoter in your area or contact Kathleen in the Parish Office. If you're not in, you can't win!

BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER will be installed as the new Bishop of Derry next Sunday, 20 September, in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, at 3.00pm. As the diocese and parishes prepare to celebrate this joyous occasion, Bishop McKeown has invited the priests of the diocese to hold special times of prayer in our parishes this week, to pray for Bishop Router as he takes up the responsibility of leading and serving the people of the diocese as Bishop. In our Pastoral Area we will have special prayers for Bishop Router at our 10.00am weekday Masses this week - on **Wednesday (Drumquin), Thursday (Aghyaran) and Friday (Castlederg)**. Children from our primary schools will attend these Masses. You are invited to come along, if you can, to join in prayer for Bishop Router at this significant time for him and for our diocese. We will also have special prayers at our Masses next weekend.

This is also a significant week for Bishop McKeown, who will retire as of next Sunday. At this time of transition for him, you are asked to keep Bishop McKeown in your prayers too.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 14 September: Drumquin Town Area - Segully Road, McCreagh Park, Castlederg Road, Main Street, Creaghmore Road, Fairgreen Gardens and Loughrey Terrace, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

ST VINCENT DE PAUL members will meet in the Parochial House, Drumquin this Wednesday, 16 September, at 7.30pm. If you would like to become involved in SVP, you are very welcome to come along to this meeting.

PIONEER MEETING will take place in the Parochial House, Drumquin, this Thursday, 17 September, at 7.30pm.

QUEEN'S UNIVERSITY CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14 September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. The first Sunday Mass will be celebrated on 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle-lighting — and call into Mosaic for coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats.

YOGA CLASS: Aghyaran Development Association in conjunction with HARC is commencing a 6-week Yogo class for over 50's in Aghyaran Centre, commencing Tues 15 September, 11.30am - 12.30pm. Contact Jerry on 078 6492 9344.

LINE DANCING in Garvagh Hall commences on Monday 21 September: Absolute Beginners – 6.00pm - 7.30pm; High Beginners/Improvers - 7.45pm - 9.30pm. Doors open 5.45pm. Adults £7, Children under 10 £5 (must be accompanied by an adult). Wear comfortable footwear and bring a bottle of water.

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

EARLY TO TALK ABOUT CHRISTMAS, BUT TROCAIRE WANT TO KNOW - Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell **Trócaire's Gifts of Change** — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need, including training and support. If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call **028 9080 8030**.

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

With the theme of 'Living Water' for this year's Season of Creation, we pray:

Holy God, whose Spirit hovered over the waters at the beginning,
we gather as part of your community of all creation, thirsty for your grace.
We give thanks for the gift of water, the veins of our common home,
that sustains the cedar and the whale, the pasture and the city.
We are grateful for the local waters that nourish our homelands and our fellow creatures.
We give thanks that in your well-watered garden, every drop is a sacred testament to your love.
Yet, we confess that we have treated this gift as a mere commodity.
We have choked the seas with our waste and watched the warming tides rise in judgment.
Melt our frozen hearts, O God, and let the waters of repentance flow.
Lord of all Life, you promised that wherever the river flows, everything shall live.
Stir in us a calling to care for the waters and to honour the dignity of the thirsty.
May your Word be a spring within us, gushing forth for the healing of the nations.
May Christ our Lord who is Living Water refresh us for the work of restoration.
And may the Holy Spirit carry us on currents of grace until justice rolls down like waters
and righteousness like an ever-flowing stream. Amen.